

The Working Day

Guide for running the course with your team

Free security training for staff at UK small businesses. "The Working Day" is a browser-based course with fictional work tasks, followed by a short team discussion.

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1. What this is

Staff work through a fictional day from home or another location. They meet requests from someone claiming to be the boss, a suspicious sign-in page, public wireless networks and a lost device. They choose what to do and see what follows. The course covers:

- **Remote working:** home and public networks, device care, working where others can see the screen.
- **Deceptive requests:** messages and calls that trick people into sharing information or allowing access, often by rushing them.
- **Reporting concerns:** knowing what to report, who to tell and how quickly. Report anything that may have harmed accounts, devices or information, even if you are unsure.

Planning estimate: 45 to 60 minutes for tasks, reading and assessment, plus 15 minutes of discussion. This has not been tested with real learners. Allow extra time and see how your team gets on.

You do not need computer knowledge to run this. Your job is to set up a calm room, brief people on your own reporting rules, and lead the discussion. The game does the teaching. You are not expected to answer specialist questions. "I will find out" is a good answer.

2. What it is not

- It is not an officially recognised qualification or proof that legal requirements are met. It does not send results to a central employer training system. The course sets its own completion mark of 13 out of 16. Passing does not show that your business meets data protection law or has approval under the separate Cyber Essentials scheme, which checks security protections on computers and accounts.
- It is not a complete plan for handling security problems. It does not replace your own policies, computer and account protections, or advice from your support team. Act on a real concern now. Do not wait until training ends.
- It is a way to start useful conversations and build habits. Treat it as one part of looking after security, not the whole of it.

3. Before the session

1. Pick a date and time. Choose a time when people are not rushed. Tell the team the purpose in advance: practice, not a competition or proof of workplace competence.
2. **Get the game.** Either use the online course at <https://baptistsec.github.io/the-working-day/> or extract the full download from <https://payhip.com/b/1y26E> and open index.html in a web browser. Try it yourself on one device first.
3. Complete the briefing on your workplace rules in section 4. Allow 10 to 15 minutes. Agree the reporting contacts and routes before staff start.
4. **Plan support.** See section 10 for accessibility and help. Ask in advance if anyone needs adjustments.
5. **Book the discussion.** Keep the 15 minutes after play in the same session, while the scenarios are fresh.

4. Workplace rules (fill in before the session)

The game teaches general good habits. It cannot know who your staff should contact or what your rules are. Fill in this table and read it out at the start. Where you do not have an answer, write "not decided yet" and agree one before the session. Do not guess or copy another business's answer.

Who to tell first if something looks wrong	[name / role and how to reach them]
Backup if that person is away	[name / role and how to reach them]
How quickly to report	[for example: straight away, even if unsure]
If you think you clicked something bad	[stop interacting, report what you did; follow the appropriate steps below]
Lost or stolen device	[who to tell and what happens next]
Our work computer support team or provider (if any)	[name and contact, or "none"]
Approved devices and software for work	[your rules]
Rules for working in public places	[your rules]
Payment or bank detail change requests	[how these must be checked before acting]
Urgent or out-of-hours contact	[name and number for evenings, weekends and holidays]
If email may be accessed by someone else, another way to reach the contact	[for example phone number or messaging app, not email]
Where security reports are kept safely	[location with restricted access]
Where this policy is written down	[location, or "not yet written"]

Tip: if payment changes and urgent requests from senior staff come up in the game, point back to your answers here.

Two situations to explain clearly

The game covers these and people often mix them up. Make sure your table answers match.

- **Possible harmful software or device problem:** if a strange file was run and files change or stop opening, stop work and report urgently. Follow your agreed instructions for disconnecting the device so the problem cannot spread. Do not erase or reset it without permission; that can destroy useful evidence.
- **Password entered on a suspicious page:** stop using the page and report what you entered and when, without including the password. Follow the genuine service or support team instructions to change it. The team may also need to sign the account out on devices or apps where it is already signed in. A password change does not always do that.

5. Running the session

Suggested timings

0:00 to 0:15	Welcome, purpose, message welcoming honest reports (below), read out the workplace-rules table, answer questions.
0:15 to 1:10	Everyone plays at their own pace. Aim for 45 to 60 minutes including reading, modules and assessment. Early finishers can stop or help a colleague.
1:10 to 1:25	Team discussion (section 6).
1:25 to 1:30	Agree one or two actions and who owns them. Thank everyone.

How to open

Say something like: "This is practice, not a competition or proof of workplace competence. Nobody is being scored against colleagues. Mistakes in the game are useful. I would rather you get things wrong here than for real."

During play

- Let people work alone or in pairs. Pairs often talk through choices, which helps.
- Walk around, or check in if it is remote. Do not look over shoulders at choices.
- Do not give answers. If someone is stuck, suggest they read the situation again and think about what they would do on a normal workday.
- Note questions about your own rules. You will use them in the discussion.
- Remote teams: run it as a video call. People play on their own device and rejoin the call for the discussion.

If someone finishes early or struggles

There is no need for anyone to replay. Early finishers can stop or help a colleague. If someone finds it hard, offer to play together or give extra time. See section 10.

If you split the session

Optional saving keeps progress in the same browser on the same device. Do not use it on a shared device. Progress is not copied between devices. If someone changes device or browser, use [Learning-Transcript.html](#), the printable reading version, for assisted discussion.

6. Team discussion (15 minutes)

Keep the group together. Ask the questions below, one at a time, and let people answer in their own words. Use a notepad or whiteboard for actions. You can skip questions if time is short.

3 min	What was the most believable situation in the game? What made it believable?
3 min	What was one moment where you were tempted to rush? What would help you slow down?
3 min	Who would you tell if something like this happened tomorrow? (Check people give the contact from section 4.)
3 min	What would make it easier to report something, even if you were not sure or were embarrassed?
3 min	What is one thing we will do differently, and who will take it forward?

Close by thanking people for taking part and repeating the reporting contact one more time.

7. No-blame reporting culture

Delay can make a security problem harder to stop. People report sooner when they trust they will be listened to.

- **Make one promise, and keep it.** Say: "Honest reporting is welcome. We will focus on support and fixes. Any conduct rules that are relevant, we will explain before you play." Then explain those rules before the game starts. Do not promise more than that.
- **Go first.** Share a time you nearly fell for something, or a small mistake of your own.
- **Make the route easy.** One named person, one clear way to reach them, no forms to fill in first.
- **Focus on fixing.** When something happens, ask "what do we do now and what would help next time" before "how did this happen".

8. Manager card for receiving security reports

Use this when someone reports a concern. It is a starting point, not a complete plan for handling security problems. Act on a real concern now; do not wait for training to finish.

1. Thank them	Thank the reporter every time, even if it turns out to be harmless. Do not ask who is to blame.
2. Get it to the right person	Pass it quickly to the responsible person or backup named in section 4. Use the urgent contact out of hours.
3. Write down the facts	Record what happened, when it was noticed, which device and service, what has been done so far, and what data may be involved. Never write passwords or codes in the record.
4. Stop further harm	Stop the problem spreading. Follow your existing plan. Keep evidence: do not delete, wipe or reset anything unless your plan says to. Limit who is told to people who need to know.
5. Name the responsible person	Name one person responsible for the report and agree when the next update will be.
6. Who outside must be told	The authorised team decides whether anyone outside must be told (for example the UK data protection regulator, customers, insurer or police). Managers should not decide this alone.

Practise once before staff use: a fictional report

Agree the rehearsal with the person responsible for handling security concerns. Use a fictional report through your internal route. Mark it as practice and agree who is involved and when. Use no real information, passwords or codes. Do not contact anyone outside the organisation, customers or banks. Check that someone answers, accepts responsibility, knows where to keep the record and agrees the next update. Fix any gaps before staff start.

Legal detail if personal information is involved

A personal-data breach is a security problem involving loss, destruction, change, damage, improper sharing or access to information about identifiable people; unavailability can count too. The organisation deciding why and how the information is used records every personal-data breach and the reasons for its decisions, even when it does not need to tell the regulator. It must tell the regulator unless a risk to people's rights and freedoms is unlikely. This assessment includes possible harm to privacy, fraud, discrimination and other harm to the people affected. A required report is due without unnecessary delay and, where possible, within 72 hours of that organisation becoming aware. If the risk to people is high, that organisation must tell them without unnecessary delay. One handling information for it following its instructions tells it without unnecessary delay once aware of a breach, regardless of the regulator reporting risk threshold. It must not wait 72 hours. Sources checked 6 October 2026: regulator guidance linked in Source-Notes.txt. Check current guidance before later use. Not legal advice.

9. Privacy and the completion record

- **Name is optional.** Players may type a name for a printed page. It is used for printing only and is not saved. Players can leave it blank.
- Activity and results are not sent to us or an employer. Optional progress is stored only in this browser on this device. A hosting provider may record normal page requests under its own policy. Download sites have their own privacy practices. These are separate from the course.
- Optional saving in the browser. If enabled and available, the browser keeps task choices, inspected details, setup and module checks, unfinished assessment answers and current question, and result/date. It does not share these with you. Clearing browser data, using private browsing or changing device can lose progress.
- A browser record, not proof. It does not prove who completed the course and can be changed by the learner. It is not an officially recognised qualification or proof of legal compliance. Do not use it as proof for an auditor, insurer, client or regulator.
- **For an attendance record,** keep your own simple note (names and date) and tell staff what you record and why. Apply your normal data protection practices to it.
- **Do not ask people to share their choices or results.** Invite them to talk about them in the discussion if they want to.
- Apart from the optional real name, no other real personal or customer data should be entered into the game. Never enter real passwords.

10. Introducing the course and giving support

Introducing it to a team

- **Small teams:** one session for everyone.
- **Larger or shift-based teams:** two or three shorter sessions. Brief each group the same way using the section 4 table.
- **Remote or hybrid teams:** a video call session works well. Send the game files (or tell people how to get them) and the policy table beforehand.
- **New starters:** invite them to play in their first few weeks. Repeat yearly or when your rules change.
- **Afterwards:** check in a few weeks later. Ask whether anyone has reported something, and thank them for doing so.

Accessibility and support

Automated checks are not a test with real learners or assistive tools. Check the course with the people who will use it and have a reading or assisted-discussion alternative ready.

- Ask in advance what adjustments people need. Offer them without making a fuss.
- Let people use their preferred device, browser zoom, screen magnifier or other assistive tools, and check these work for them before the session.
- Give extra time. The 45 to 60 minute figure is a planning estimate, not a target.
- Offer a paired option where one person reads aloud or both talk through the choices.
- If the interactive course does not work for someone, use Learning-Transcript.html, the printable reading version. It includes reference notes, tasks and their possible outcomes for assisted discussion. Use it with the discussion questions and your workplace-rules table.
- Do not require anyone to disclose a reason for needing support.
- Name someone who can help with computer problems: [name].

Quick checklist: game opens from index.html | workplace-rules table filled in | reporting contact told and ready | message welcoming honest reports prepared | adjustments asked about | discussion booked | people responsible for actions agreed after.

General awareness training, not legal or professional security advice.